

Toner price: Cost is always a primary consideration when buying any product. A printer's cost effectiveness depends on the cost of the product plus the cost of printing a page. The lower the cost per page, the better. To check this, we calculated

the price of the toner in relation with the specified life of the toner.

Here the HP printers come out tops. Printing on any one of these printers, be it the HP Laserjet 1000 or the Laserjet 1200, will cost you just 88 paise per page. If running cost is of concern, these printers would keep your expenditure to a minimum. The Epson EPL-5900L also provides good value for money, where printing a

document will cost you 93 paise. This value is very close to that of the Wipro Laser 1540, which delivered printing costs of 95 paise per page. The printer that offered the lowest value as far as toner price is considered was the Lexmark E322. Here printing a document would cost you Rs 1.74.

Accessories: An important feature that most manufacturers miss is the inclusion of an interface cable (either USB or parallel). Hunting for an interface cable after purchasing the printer can be a very time consuming and unwelcoming task. Here the Canon LBP 1210, Epson EPL-5900L, the Lexmark E210 and E322 and the Wipro 1540 scored over the others by providing the respective interface cables.

Documentation: It always helps if a manufacturer provides a detailed user manual that is lucid and simple to understand. This is especially applicable to the quick setup guide—by referring to this quick start guide, a user can easily get the printer up and running in the least possible time. The printers in the comparison that did not provide a quick start guide were the Canon LBP 1120, the HP Laserjet 1000 and 1200 and the Lexmark E322. All the other printers included a quick start guide.

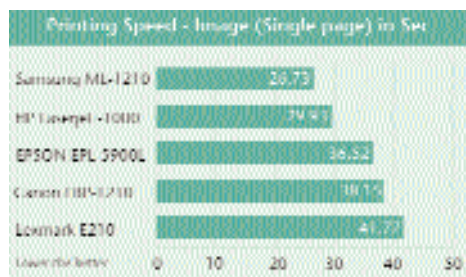
Build quality

Here we noted the build quality of each printer in specific areas such as the sturdiness of the paper feed tray, paper-out tray and toner flap—all three areas have moveable parts and are handled the most. All the printers featured good build quality in these areas. The only exception was the Wipro Laser 1540—though it has a good build quality, we found the paper-in tray to be somewhat flimsy.

Performance

In our performance tests we checked the printers for speed and quality. To judge the speed of the printers, we printed different file types such as image, text and combinational documents including text and graphics.

Speed: In the speed tests, we first printed a TIFF image document and noted the time taken. In this test, the Samsung ML-1210 came out tops, logging just 26.73



1/2 page Ver. AD